

INTERVIEW TRANSCRIPT - MARCUS CHEN

INTERNAL INVESTIGATION - INTERVIEW TRANSCRIPT

Date: March 5, 2024

Time: 10:00 AM - 11:45 AM

Location: Conference Room B, Head Office

Interviewee: Marcus Chen, Senior Procurement Manager

Interviewer: Sarah Mitchell, Chief Compliance Officer

Also Present: James Wong, Legal Counsel

[Recording begins]

SM: Mr. Chen, thank you for coming in today. As you know, we're investigating certain payments made to Nexus Trading Ltd. You were the one who onboarded this vendor, correct?

MC: Yes, that's correct. Nexus provides strategic consulting services.

SM: Can you describe what services they provided?

MC: They... they help with market analysis and strategic planning. Executive-level consulting.

SM: Do you have any reports or deliverables from these engagements?

MC: Those would be with the executive team. I just manage the vendor relationship.

SM: Our records show over €1 million was paid to Nexus in 2023. That's significant for a consulting engagement. Was this approved by the board?

MC: I... I believe it went through proper channels.

SM: Mr. Chen, we've reviewed the approval chain. You approved these invoices, and David Okonkwo processed them. There's no board approval, no tender process, and no evidence of any services rendered.

MC: I'd like to speak with a lawyer.

JW: Mr. Chen, I'm here as company counsel, but if you'd prefer personal representation, we can pause this interview.

MC: Yes. I want my own lawyer.

SM: Very well. This interview is suspended at 10:32 AM. Mr. Chen, you are suspended with pay pending further investigation. Please surrender your company laptop and access cards.

[Recording ends]